

THE CIRCLE OF FIFTHS

All 12 major keys organized by harmonic distance — adjacent keys share 6 notes, opposite keys share almost none.

12 KEYS — CLOCKWISE = +1 SHARP (UP A PERFECT 5TH)



CLOCKWISE ►

+1 Sharp · Up a Perfect 5th

C → G → D → A → E → B → F $\sharp$

Each step adds one sharp: F $\sharp$ C $\sharp$ G $\sharp$ D $\sharp$ A $\sharp$ E $\sharp$ B $\sharp$

COUNTER-CLOCKWISE ◄

+1 Flat · Up a Perfect 4th

C → F → B $\flat$ → E $\flat$ → A $\flat$ → D $\flat$ → G $\flat$

Each step adds one flat: B $\flat$ E $\flat$ A $\flat$ D $\flat$ G $\flat$ C $\flat$ F $\flat$

ORDER OF SHARPS (FCGDAEB)

F $\sharp$ C $\sharp$ G $\sharp$ D $\sharp$ A $\sharp$ E $\sharp$ B $\sharp$

ORDER OF FLATS (BEADGCF)

B $\flat$ E $\flat$ A $\flat$ D $\flat$ G $\flat$ C $\flat$ F $\flat$

HARMONIC DISTANCE

Adjacent keys (C ↔ G)

Share 6 of 7 notes. Closely related — key changes feel smooth and natural. One accidental difference.

Tritone-apart keys (C ↔ F $\sharp$)

Share only 0–1 notes. Maximum harmonic distance. Distant key changes are dramatic and disorienting.